

Department of Artificial Intelligence & Data Science

School of Computing, FAST-NUCES

Course Title: Natural Language Processing (NLP)

Class: MS-AI/DS

Instructor: Dr. Zohair Ahmed

Total Marks: 10

Due Date: Next class. No extension. Late submissions will not be accepted.

- Viva or quiz may be conducted in the next class based on the assignment.
- Students must prepare the concepts.
- Blind copy-paste is not acceptable.

Task 1 Paper and Reflection Report

Instructions to Students

- Read the paper:
Emily M. Bender & Alexander Koller (2020),
“Climbing towards NLU: On Meaning, Form, and Understanding in the Age of Data.”
<https://aclanthology.org/2020.acl-main.463>
- Answer the questions **by hand** on 1–2 pages maximum.
- Use **short paragraphs or bullet points**.
- Bring your handwritten sheets to the **next class**.

Questions (students must answer all)

1. **Very short summary (5–6 lines maximum)**

- What is the **main problem** the authors are worried about?

- In your own words, what is their **main message**?

2. **Connection to our class (5–8 lines)**

Use terms from the first lecture:

- Where do you see:
 - **Datasets / corpora**

- **Bias or fairness**

- **Low-resource languages or “only English” focus**

- Mention at least **two** of these and give **one concrete sentence** from the paper or a paraphrase.

3. **Language is situated (4–6 lines)**

- According to our class and the book, language is produced by **who, where, when, for what purpose**.
- Explain **one example** from the paper that shows why it is dangerous to ignore this (for example, treating “English web text” as if it represents all language or all people).

4. **Your opinion (4–6 lines)**

- Do you **agree or disagree** with the authors’ concerns?
- Give **one concrete reason** based on: any NLP application we discussed (search, assistants, translation, toxicity, etc.), or your own experience with language or technology.